

Examine the properties of natural and made materials including fibres, metals, glass and plastics and consider how these properties influence their use

Learning intention

- examine the properties of natural and made materials including fibres, metals, glass and plastics and consider how these properties influence their use.

Teach and model

- investigating familiar objects, such as shoes, drink containers or backpacks.
- investigating which materials can be recycled and researching alternatives for materials such as single use plastics.
- designing, building and testing an object or structure for a specific purpose, such as a tent, lunchbox or bird feeder.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.